

BODY DECODE • FOUR PATTERNS

The Order

Which fix goes with which pattern. And why the order matters more than the fix.

Four patterns. Four different fixes. Run the wrong one and the plan half works.

But there is a step before that, and almost everyone skips it.

A fix only works on a body that is in a state to use it.

Get that order wrong and even the right fix does nothing. Which is how people end up deciding the whole approach failed, when really the order failed.

The order

1. **Find out what your body is actually doing.** Not what plan you fancy. What state you are in right now.
2. **Get the basics off the floor.** Sleep, food, training load. Whatever is worst comes up first.
3. **Then fix the pattern.** Now the specific work will actually do something.

THE SIGNAL THAT DECIDES IT

Skip step one and steps two and three are guesswork.

Skip step two and step three lands on a body with nothing spare to spend. So your effort turns into tiredness instead of change.

A body in protection mode does not respond to a better program. It responds to the pressure coming off. That is not a mindset thing. It is a fuel thing.

1 Cortisol · the stress one

Where it sits: front of your stomach, while your arms and legs stay lean.

What fixes it: taking the load off, and protecting your sleep.

What makes it worse: more training, and eating less. Both land as more pressure on a body that is already defending itself. This is the pattern where a good week tempts you to add a fourth hard session, and that is exactly the wrong move.

The bit that feels backwards. On this one, the plan usually needs to go down, not up.

2 Insulin · the food-timing one

Where it sits: mid-back, lower back and your sides, with the front of your stomach comparatively flat.

What fixes it: when you eat, and what you eat alongside your carbs.

What makes it worse: nothing dramatic, and that is the trap. This is the one pattern where normal advice genuinely half works. You get some movement, you assume the plan was right, then it stalls and you assume that part was you.

The bit that feels backwards. Cutting carbs out is not the answer. Timing and pairing move this more reliably, and you can actually live like that past a fortnight.

3 Oestrogen · women

Where it sits: hips, bum and outer thighs. Later it starts moving toward your middle.

What fixes it: eating consistently and properly.

What makes it worse: cutting back. Your body reads it as food being scarce, holds on harder, and the harder you push the tighter it grips. On this pattern the standard advice does not just fail. It actively works against you.

The bit that feels backwards. This one has two stages that need different handling. Fat sitting on your hips is one thing. That same fat moving to your middle while you lose muscle is another.

What decides which is the movement, not your cycle and not where it sits today. Has where you store it changed over the last few years, and which way did it go? If your middle has always been your middle, this is not the pattern you are looking at, it is cortisol.

4 Testosterone · men

Where it sits: nowhere specific. Your middle fills out while muscle, strength and drive all drop together.

What fixes it: protecting your muscle, before anything else.

What makes it worse: hard dieting. It costs you the muscle you were trying to keep. Less muscle means more testosterone gets converted away, which means more fat. The diet feeds the problem.

The bit that feels backwards. The sign is the muscle going, not the fat arriving. Putting on fat by itself does not mean this is you.

TRY THIS WEEK

Before you pick a fix, do step two for one week.

Whichever pattern you think is yours, step two is the same for all four, and it is the only step you can safely take without knowing which one you are in.

Pick the single thing that is most obviously on the floor. Sleep, food, or how hard you are training. Bring that one up for a week. Do not add anything, and do not cut anything.

If a week of that changes how you feel, your foundation was the problem and the pattern work was never going to land on top of it anyway.

What happens when you run the wrong fix

IF YOU DO THIS	ON CORTISOL	ON INSULIN	ON OESTROGEN	ON TESTOSTERONE
Train harder	Worse. More pressure.	Some effect.	Worse if you eat less too.	Depends if you keep the muscle.
Cut calories hard	Worse. More pressure.	Works, then stalls.	Worse. Reads as scarcity.	Worse. Costs you muscle.
Cut out carbs	Little effect, and less fuel.	Half works, then returns.	Worse when it drops your food.	Little effect on the real cause.
Drop the load, protect sleep	This is the fix.	Fine to helpful.	Helpful.	Helpful.

Look at the bottom row against the top three.

The exact advice that fixes one pattern makes two of the others worse.

That is not a willpower problem. It is an aiming problem, and trying harder does not fix aim.

This is a map, not an answer. These patterns can change as your body changes. If nothing here quite fits you, that is a real answer rather than a fail, and a body that is working well will not fit any of them.

Do not start a fix based on a guess. The whole reason the order matters is that step three is cheap and effective once one and two are done, and expensive and pointless before that. Picking the closest-looking pattern off a page and jumping to its fix is the same mistake in a different outfit.

WANT TO KNOW WHICH ONE IS ACTUALLY YOURS?

The free **14-Day Body Decode Challenge** asks you some questions on day one, checks eight things against your own starting point on day seven, and tells you your pattern on day fourteen. Which one is running yours, and what to do about that specific one.

Free. Nothing to pay to get your read.

bodyrecode.au/challenge